Cum diuturnum

Leo XIII · 1898-12-25 · Latin

LITTERAE S. D. N. Leonis Xiii ad Ordinarios Americae Latinae qui Romam deli- gunt pro consiliis inter eosdem habendis.

C u m d i u t u r n u m r e c o l i m u s Pontificatus Nostri c u r s u m , ni- hil u n q u a m p r a e t e r m i s i s s e v i d e m u r , q u o d a d c o n s t a b i l i e n d u m in istis g e n t i b u s p r o m o v e n d u m q u e Christi r e g n u m pertineret. R e r u m q u i d e m , q u a s D e o opitulante a d h u c vestra c a u s a g e s - s i m u s , m a n e t a p u d v o s m e m o r i a e t gratia, V e n e r a b i l e s Fra- t r e s ; q u o r u m navitati diligentiaeque illa providentiae N o s t r a e officia h a u d frustra c o m m e n d a v i m u s . — N u n c v e r o Nostri er- g a v o s animi n o v u m e x t a r e d o c u m e n t u m v o l u m u s ; i d q u o d i a m d i u N o b i s in optatis fuit. Etenim ex q u o t e m p o r e saecula- ria s o l l e m n i a a g e b a n t u r q u a r t u m o b m e m o r i a m detectae A m e - ricae, s e d u l o cogitare c o e p i m u s , q u a p o t i s s i m u m via c o m m u - n i b u s rationibus latini nominis, n o v u m o r b e m p l u s dimidia parte obtinentis, p r o s p i c e r e p o s s e m u s . Optimum a u t e m a d e a m r e m fore p e r s p e x i m u s , si quotquot e s s e t i s ex istis civitatibus Epi- scopi c o n s u l t u m inter v o s , i n v i t a t i et auctoritate Nostra, con- v e n i s t i s . S i q u i d e m conferendis consiliis s o c i a n d i s q u e p r u d e n - tiae f r u c t i b u s , q u o s c u i q u e v e s t r u m u s u s r e r u m peperisset, apte p e r v o s p r o v i s u m iri intelligebamus, ut a p u d e a s g e n t e s , q u a s i d e m aut certe c o g n a t u m g e n u s c o n i u n c t a s teneret, uni- tas ecclesiasticae disciplinae s a l v a consisteret, v i g e s c e r e n t digni catholica professione m o r e s , atque c o n cordibus b o n o r u m stu- diis Ecclesia publice floreret. Illud etiam m a g n o p e r e s u a d e b a t initum e x e q u i consilium, q u o d v o s sententiam rogati, h u i u s - m o d i p r o p o s i t u m ingenti c u m a s s e n s u e x c e p i s s e t i s . — Ut a u - t e m venit perficiendae rei maturitas, o p t i o n e m v o b i s fecimus, V e n e r a b i l e s Fratres, u t eligeretis l o c u m , ubi i d h a b e n d u m e s s e concilium videretur. Porro a u t e m v o s m a x i m a m p a r t e m signifi- castis coituros libentius R o m a m , o b e a m q u o q u e c a u s a m , q u o d pluribus v e s t r u m expeditior h u c pateret aditus, q u a m propter difficillima istic itinera ad l o n g i n q u a m aliquam a m e r i c a n a m ur- b e m . Huic declarationi sententiae vestrae, q u a e n o n l e v e h a b e - bat indicium a m o r i s in A p o s t o l i c a m s e d e m , fieri n o n potuit, quin m a g n a a N o b i s c o m p r o b a t i o accederet. Q u a m q u a m m o - leste ferimus, q u a n u n c conditione s u m u s , a d e m p t a m N o b i s facultatem u n d e v o s , R o m a e d u m eritis, t a m liberaliter h o n e - s t e q u e tractemus, q u a m v e l i m u s . Igitur s a c r u m Consilium Tri-

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dentinis decretis interpretandis habet i a m a N o b i s in mandatis, ut concilium E p i s c o p o r u m o m n i u m e rebuspublicis A m e r i c a e , latinae R o m a m c o n v o c e t i n a n n u m p r o x i m u m , atque o p p o r t u n e praescribat, q u a s illud ad l e g e s dirigi oporteat. Interea c a e l e s t i u m m u n e r u m a u s p i c e m , t e s t e m q u e b e n e v o - lentiae N o s t r a e vobis, V e n e r a b i l e s Fratres, et c l e r o p o p u l o q u e singulis concredito A p o s t o l i c a m b e n e d i c t i o n e m peramanter im- pertimus. D a t u m R o m a e a p u d S. P e t r u m ipsa die natali D. N. I e s u MDCCCXCVIII, Pontificatus Nostri a n n o v i c e s i m o primo.

LEO P P . XIII.

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